Exercise 4

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Create a prototype with familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements. Evaluate ease of use with different user groups using Wireflow.

FRAME 1:

LOGIN PAGE:

Chunking Analysis of the Login Page

The Login Page is the entry point of the prototype. It incorporates both familiar authentication patterns and subtle unfamiliar elements to evaluate how different user groups respond to the initial screen.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - This is the authentication screen where users enter their credentials to access the application.
   - The screen tests whether standard login patterns are immediately recognisable and usable across all user groups.

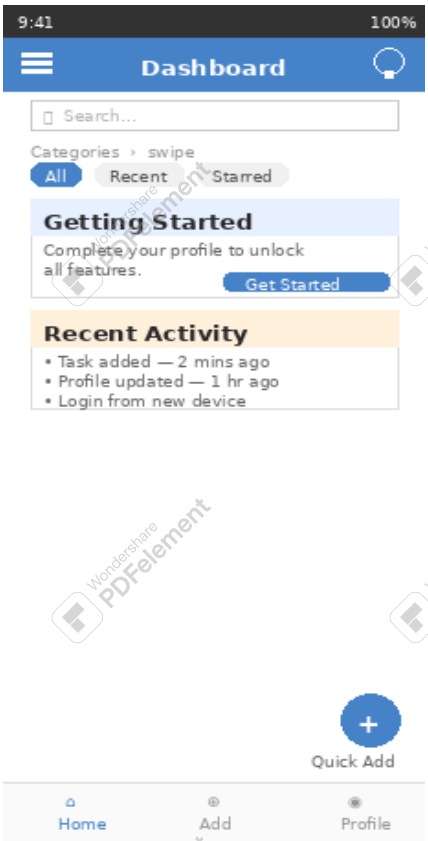
2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Username & Password Fields –
     - Standard labelled input fields positioned vertically, matching the most common login layout.
     - Placeholder text ('Enter username', 'Password') guides users without adding clutter.
   - LOG IN Button –
     - A large, full-width blue button below the fields — the standard CTA placement familiar to all users.
   - Forgot Password Link –
     - Right-aligned text link below the password field — a familiar secondary action pattern.
   - Social Sign-In Buttons (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - Google and Facebook buttons are placed side by side below a divider — users unfamiliar with OAuth flows may not know these link to external accounts.
   - Sign Up Link –
     - A text-only link at the bottom for new users — familiar pattern but easy to overlook without a distinct button style.

3. How the Login Page Works
   1. User enters username and password into the respective input fields.
   2. User clicks LOG IN or presses Enter to authenticate.
   3. Alternatively, user taps Google or Facebook for social sign-in.
   4. New users tap 'Sign Up' to navigate to the registration screen.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Familiar layout reduces time-to-first-action — users recognise the form immediately.
- Minimal elements on screen lower cognitive load, helping less tech-savvy users focus.
- Social sign-in options reduce friction for users who prefer not to remember passwords.
- The ‘Forgot password?’ link provides a safety net, reducing anxiety around login errors.

FRAME 2:
HOME PAGE (DASHBOARD):



Chunking Analysis of the Home Page

The Home Page is the main screen users land on after logging in. It introduces both familiar content cards and several unfamiliar navigation elements designed to test user adaptability.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - This is the primary navigation hub, where users access key features such as browsing, adding content, and viewing recent activity.
   - The screen tests how quickly users can orient themselves and discover both obvious and hidden navigation elements.

2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Top Bar with Hamburger Menu (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A three-line icon in the top-left corner hides the full navigation drawer. Users unfamiliar with this pattern may not tap it.
     - The notification bell icon in the top-right is recognisable but requires prior experience with icon-only navigation.
   - Search Bar –
     - A standard search input at the top of the content area — familiar to all user groups.
   - Swipeable Category Chips (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - Horizontal filter pills (All, Recent, Starred) that scroll sideways. The gesture is not signposted, making it discoverable only through exploration.
   - Content Cards –
     - Two grouped cards ('Getting Started' and 'Recent Activity') present structured information in a familiar card-layout pattern.
   - Floating Action Button / FAB (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A circular '+' button floating in the bottom-right corner for a 'Quick Add' action. Its purpose is not obvious until tapped.
   - Bottom Navigation Bar –
     - Three-tab bar (Home, Add, Profile) at the bottom — the standard mobile navigation pattern.

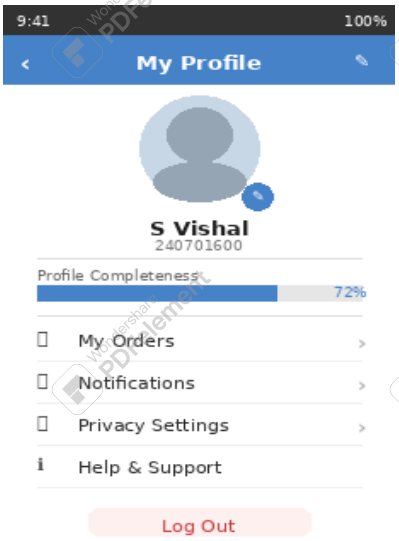
3. How the Home Page Works
   1. User arrives at the Dashboard after logging in.

2. User taps the hamburger icon to access the hidden side navigation drawer.
3. User swipes the category chips horizontally to filter content.
4. User taps the FAB to quickly add a new item without navigating away.
5. User taps a bottom tab to switch between main sections.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- The card layout groups related content together, reducing visual noise and aiding quick scanning.
- The persistent bottom nav bar gives users a reliable anchor for primary navigation.
- The FAB reduces the number of steps needed to perform the most common action.
- Unfamiliar elements (hamburger menu, swipeable chips) test adaptability — experienced users find them immediately, while newer users may need guidance.

FRAME 3:
PROFILE PAGE:



Chunking Analysis of the Profile Page

The Profile Page displays the user's personal information, account settings, and progress. It combines familiar list-based navigation with unfamiliar gamification and inline editing elements.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - This screen allows users to view and manage their personal account details, track their profile completeness, and navigate to sub-sections such as Orders and Notifications.
   - It evaluates whether users understand progress indicators and inline photo editing affordances without instruction.

2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Profile Avatar with Edit Badge (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A small pencil icon overlaid on the avatar signals it is tappable to change the photo. This affordance is subtle and often missed by first-time users.
   - Name and ID Display –
     - User's name and roll number displayed below the avatar — a standard profile header pattern.
   - Profile Completeness Progress Bar (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A horizontal bar showing 72% profile completion. This gamification element motivates users to fill in missing details but is unexpected in a conventional profile page.
   - List Menu Items –
     - My Orders, Notifications, Privacy Settings, and Help & Support are presented as tappable rows with right-pointing arrows — a universally familiar settings list pattern.
   - Log Out Button –
     - A lightly styled red button at the bottom of the screen — familiar placement but uses color to signal a destructive action.

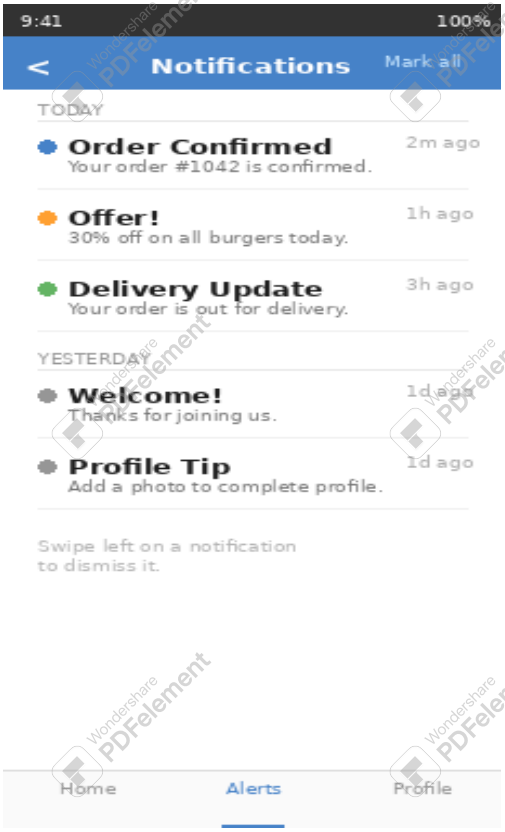
3. How the Profile Page Works
   1. User views their name, ID, and avatar at the top of the screen.
   2. User taps the pencil badge on the avatar to change their profile photo.

3. User views the progress bar and taps incomplete fields to improve their score.
4. User taps any menu row to navigate to the corresponding section.
5. User taps Log Out to end their session and return to the Login Page.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- The progress bar creates a goal-oriented experience, encouraging profile completion through visual feedback.
- The list-style menu groups all account actions into a single scannable section, reducing navigation effort.
- Consistent use of right-pointing arrows signals tappability, setting correct user expectations.
- The Log Out button's red colouring communicates its destructive nature without requiring a label change.

FRAME 4:
NOTIFICATIONS PAGE:



Chunking Analysis of the Notifications Page

The Notifications Page displays a chronological feed of system alerts and updates. It uses familiar list grouping with an unfamiliar swipe-to-dismiss gesture pattern to test gesture-based navigation.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - This screen presents all recent user notifications grouped by time period (Today, Yesterday), enabling users to quickly scan and act on relevant alerts.
   - It evaluates whether users discover the swipe-to-dismiss interaction without explicit instructions.

2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Top Bar with Back Arrow and 'Mark All' (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A standard back arrow returns the user to the previous screen — familiar across all platforms.
     - The 'Mark all' text button in the top-right is a compact action that less experienced users may not notice or understand.
   - Time-Grouped Sections (TODAY / YESTERDAY) –
     - Notifications are divided into labelled time groups, chunking the feed into manageable segments and reducing cognitive load.
   - Notification Rows with Colour-Coded Dots –
     - Each unread notification has a coloured dot (blue, orange, green) indicating category — a visual chunking cue that speeds up scanning.
     - Title, subtitle, and timestamp are arranged in a clear hierarchy within each row.
   - Swipe-to-Dismiss Gesture (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A faint hint text ('Swipe left on a notification to dismiss it') introduces a gesture-based action. Users unfamiliar with swipe gestures may rely solely on the 'Mark all' button instead.
   - Active Tab Indicator –
     - The bottom navigation highlights the Alerts tab with a coloured underline — a familiar active-state pattern.

3. How the Notifications Page Works

1. User arrives on the Notifications page via the bottom navigation Alerts tab.
2. User scans the TODAY group for recent alerts, using colour dots to prioritise.
3. User swipes left on an individual notification to dismiss it.
4. User taps ‘Mark all’ to clear all unread notifications at once.
5. User taps the back arrow to return to the previous screen.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Time-based grouping (Today / Yesterday) chunks the notification feed, making it easier to locate recent alerts without scrolling through everything.
- Colour-coded dots allow users to identify notification types at a glance, reducing reading time.
- The swipe-to-dismiss gesture rewards experienced mobile users with an efficient interaction, while the ‘Mark all’ fallback ensures usability for all groups.
- The hint text for the swipe gesture reduces the discoverability gap, bridging familiar and unfamiliar interaction patterns.